

From Invisible to Irresistible

Rebranding & € Growth Strategy : A Conceptual Brand Strategy Case Study
Brand Strategy . Creative Direction . Social Media Management . Brand Management

Solène is not the subject. Solène is the demonstration.

This document shows how branding transitions from being invisible to irresistible
through good positioning, discipline, and organic execution.

INSIGHT → DECISION → EXECUTION → OUTCOME

PROJECT STATUS

Solène is a conceptual luxury fashion brand developed as a portfolio case study.

The intention of this project was to illustrate brand strategy development from start to finish, involving such processes as positioning, brand identity, content development, campaign development, and strategies for organic growth.

This brand has not been commercially developed, nor has any real world application taken place.

All campaign concepts, growth projections, audience assumptions, and execution frameworks as mentioned in this document are strategic recommendations meant to illustrate how one can develop a luxury fashion brand.

01 — The Insight

Luxury sells feeling, not product.

The reason why most fashion brands fail is not their lack of good products; it is their weak brand identity. They lack aesthetic consistency, an emotional value, and a voice. Fashion brands should not be interchangeable because interchangeable means invisible. We start this document with that statement because you cannot build your system right until you know your problem.

1.1 — Four Failure Patterns

There are four repeated patterns among the failing fashion brands that we will discuss in this document regardless of the quality of products or marketing campaigns. That is the ground on which the whole Solène strategy stands.

Pattern	What It Looks Like in Practice
No Identity	Unrelated logo variations, inconsistent color palette, different aesthetics in each post. The audience can't make assumptions on what the content is going to be like before opening the profile.
No Consistency	There are posts that are looking luxury and others looking affordable. The brand is confused, therefore the audience is confused. Trust needs patterns, and the lack of patterns doesn't create trust.
Selling Product, Not Feeling	Features are listed in the captions, rather than making people aspire: "soft material, 3 colours, currently available." There is nothing but transactional. There is no feeling at all.
Mistaking Empty for Minimal	White background and no text does not equal minimalism. Minimalism by definition should have all elements present for a reason. The lack of them without reason equals the lack of effort.

1.2 — The Luxury Formula

Luxury brands do not sell products. They sell the feeling of being a certain self – that which one aspires to be. In purchasing something from a luxury brand, one is purchasing a signifier, personal fulfillment, and arrival. The realization of this changes every subsequent choice made; it no longer matters whether something looks good but rather if it makes the right person feel the right way.

CORE INSIGHT

Luxury = Feeling + Exclusivity + Consistency.

Feeling: the feeling evoked by the brand before consideration of the product itself.

Exclusivity: the feeling that this isn't for everyone : and that's the whole point.

Consistency: the rigor to maintain the same aesthetic and tone through every single touchpoint.

Without any one of these three elements, the luxury branding approach fails.

1.3 — Visual Consistency as Trust Architecture

A consistent-looking feed generates more trust than an attractive-looking feed. Trust is about pattern recognition; when people open up a profile and see a coherent visual landscape, their brain interprets the coherency as integrity, which means that the brand is sure of itself.

The operational rule that follows from this principle is that every time something is about to be published, think if a stranger, looking at only this image, would be able to say it belongs to the brand. If no, the post does not go live, no matter how good-looking it is.

1.4 — The Answer Is Not a Better Product

It should be clear at this stage that the solution for Solène is not better craftsmanship or more money compared to the competitors. The solution is structural: a brand which looks like it was always here, right from the very beginning, will beat any louder or better funded brand which failed to solve its identity problem. Here we explore strategy, not capital.

02 — The Decision

“Quietly powerful.”

The two words that define every single future decision within the framework of the project. Before making any creative decisions and before crafting any visual or textual content, the only positioning axis defined was: is the choice made powerful and quietly so? Yes or no. The very same test is the whole strategy squeezed into one decision filter.

2.1 — Strategic Decisions Locked Before Execution

Decision	Rationale
Brand Aesthetic: Controlled Minimalism + Emotional Depth	Minimalism takes control of visual noise. Emotional power supplies the hook. Minimalism without emotions feels lifeless and meaningless; emotions without minimalism feel untamed and messy.
Consistency Rule	Consistent across all touchpoints: the Instagram feed, the Reels, campaign materials, direct messages, post captions, and the packaging copy. Should any piece of content break the tone defined, it will be excluded, even if it would look awesome as standalone content.
Positioning: Modern, Composed, Quietly Powerful	There is no need for the brand to declare itself. It exists with confidence. The task is significantly more challenging than loud positioning, but it is far more enduring when achieved.
The 0€ Budget Constraint	It is not a constraint : it is the discipline. Any organic reach indicator becomes a true measurement of the audience connection. Paid reach would obscure the real power of the content.

2.2 — Why a Positioning Axis, Not a Mood Board

A mood board defines how something should look like. The positioning axis defines whether something should be created in the first place. "Quietly powerful" is not an aesthetic of Pinterest — it is a test that will discard a beautiful concept if it does not align with the register of the brand. An example: a visually striking but loud campaign visual fails this test because loudness itself makes it disqualified.

THE POSITIONING TEST, APPLIED

The new idea for the Reel is a high energy transition video using viral sound clips.

Test: does this feel quietly powerful?

Answer: No : the high energy contradicts the need for composure.

Decision: reject the concept, no matter the short-term potential for virality.

2.3 — Positioning Is a Decision Filter, Not a Tagline

Every item mentioned in this report: the name, the palette, the logo, the Instagram template, the campaign — all of these concepts can be traced back to this one axis. Traceability is what differentiates a strategy from a mood board. A mood board can be described in retrospect. A strategy is able to forecast which choices should be made and which ones shouldn't.

03 — The Vehicle: Solène

Solène is the brand designed as a demonstration of the strategy. This is not what this report is about; it is rather the demonstration. Everything done for Solène, was done strategically before being creatively conceived. The next chapters contain a description of all elements of the identity system, including its name, position, color palette, logo, brand voice, and implemented assets.

3.1 — The Complete Brand Identity Board

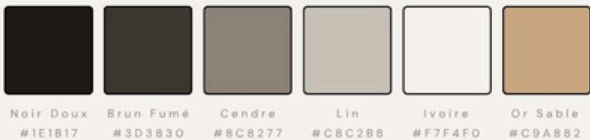
The next board contains a consolidation of the identity system in a single element: color palette, brand archetype, main logo lockups, reverse logo lockup, monogram mark, typography pairings, textures, brand voice, brand tagline, brand values, and competitive positioning.

SOLÈNE

READY-TO-WEAR · EST. 2025

BRAND IDENTITY BOARD
PRIORITY 01 OF 06
LUXURY · MINIMAL · FEMININE

COLOUR PALETTE



BRAND ARCHETYPE

The Sovereign

She does not follow trends. She sets the tone before she enters the room.

DIGNIFIED

TIMELESS

FEMININE

UNSPOKEN POWER

EFFORTLESS

PRIMARY LOGO - DARK



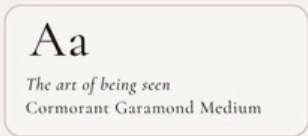
PRIMARY LOGO - LIGHT



MONOGRAM MARK



TYPOGRAPHY - DISPLAY



TYPOGRAPHY - BODY



TEXTURE PALETTE



Dark to ivory ; never saturated

BRAND VOICE

"She doesn't dress to impress. She dresses to remember."

"Crafted with intention. Worn without explanation."

"For the woman who needs no introduction."

BRAND TAGLINE

Dignified.

Always.

SOLÈNE : BRAND TAGLINE

BRAND VALUES

Ceremony

Dressing is a ritual.
Every detail is sacred.

Restraint

Nothing excess. Only
what is necessary and
beautiful.

Permanence

Made to outlast trends.
Designed to be passed
down.

COMPETITORS & POSITIONING

Sandro

→ More accessible

Isabel Marant

→ More Parisian edge

Totême

→ Direct comp

Solène lives between Sandro and

Totême: aspirational but not
untouchable.

3.2 — Brand Archetype: The Sovereign

Solène draws on The Sovereign archetype: she doesn't follow trends. She makes her presence felt even before she steps into the room. This choice was made consciously over some more popular fashion archetypes such as The Lover, The Innocent or The Rebel; sovereignty connotes power that comes with confidence and not aggression : precisely the tone set by “quietly powerful”.

Archetype Trait	Brand Expression
Dignified	No urgency words, no exclamation points, no scare tactics in copy at all.
Timeless	Seasonal trend cycle not referenced in visual identity; palette and logo timeless.
Feminine	Tonal soft serif typography and palette used with architectural composition rather than decoration.
Unspoken Power	Confidence conveyed with restraint, not proclamation.
Effortless	Each piece seems inevitable rather than hard won, while being carefully thought out.

3.3 — Brand Values

Value	Definition	Practical Application
Ceremony	Dressing is a ritual. Each element is sacred.	Content depicts dressing process as deliberate rather than hasty. No “get ready with me” fast-forward content.
Restraint	No excesses allowed, only essentials that are beautiful.	One accent color per composition. One hero statement per post. No competing visuals.
Permanence	Made to last beyond fads; designed to be inherited.	Campaigns use “made to last” framing and avoid “new season” urgency.

3.4 — Competitive Positioning

Solène was placed carefully into an already competitive field, and not an envisioned void market. This ensures the credibility of the brand rather than its inspirational character alone.

Competitor	Positioning Relationship
Sandro	More accessible than Solène. Solène is conceptually positioned above Sandro on the premium spectrum.
Isabel Marant	More Parisian coolness than Solène. Solène is sophisticated compared to the eccentric Isabel Marant.
Toteme	Closest strategic reference point. Totême acts as the primary reference for the positioning strategy.
The Row	An aspirational pinnacle. Long-term aspirational positioning reference.

Summary: Solène operates in between Sandro and Totême : aspirational, yet reachable.

04 — Decision: The Name

Why the name is a strategy, not just a label.

4.1 — Etymology

PRONUNCIATION & ORIGIN
Pronunciation: / so-LEN /
Origin:French, from Latin “sollemnis”
Core meaning:Solemn, sacred, ceremonial
Brand reading: Dignity worn lightly : the weight of occasion, carried effortlessly.

4.2 — Four Strategic Reasons Behind the Name

Reason	Explanation
The Mythology	Brand names build their own instant mythology. Solène – who is Solène? The mystery behind the name is precious. Compare it to Céline, Sandro, Isabel – the name builds the whole brand universe rather than just labeling it.
The È Advantage	The presence of the accent on the è denotes European refinement before the first word is read. This works visually and not simply as a diacritic. And it eliminates the need for a sub-brand tagline for the main logo.
The Rarity	Solène is unique, even among French names. A name that gives the impression of having been found and not created to ensure there won't be any confusion with other competitors.
The Register	A name that bears the weight of occasion without trying too hard. Ceremony without being unwearable : that's the exact energy a quiet luxury brand needs.

4.3 — The Brand Promise

The brand promise that's constructed using this name is: "For the woman who dresses for herself. Not for the room – but the room always notices." One line that works as a whole positioning strategy: it separates the brand from the act of asking for approval while acknowledging the social impact of confidence.

05 — Decision: The Colour System

The palette is the positioning made visible.

Color is the first thing the brain picks up , before even the words, the logo or the products themselves. And the Solène color palette was designed to do all of that at once: to be instantly recognizable, emotional and disciplined enough to build a strong identity in every medium, whether it's Instagram, packaging or print.

5.1 — The Full Colour Palette Board

SOLÈNE

COLOUR PALETTE BOARD

SIX PRIMARY · TWO ACCENT
TONAL FAMILY · NO SATURATED HUES
WARM NEUTRAL FOUNDATION

THE FULL PALETTE AT A GLANCE

VOIR DOUX

BRUN FUMÉ

OMBRE

CENDRE

LIN

CRAIE

IVOIRE

OR SABLE

Dominant

Secondary

Mid

Light

White

Accent

INDIVIDUAL SWATCHES

Noir Doux

#1E1B17

Primary dark · Logo · Type

Brun Fumé

#3D3830

Secondary dark · Rules

Ombre

#4A4238

Depth · Campaign · backgrounds

Cendre

#8C8277

Mid-tone · Sub-labels · Meta

Lin

#C8C2B8

Light · Borders · Dividers

Craie

#DD8D80

Very light · Inactive states

Ivoire

#F7F4F0

Page white · Brand canvas

Or Sable

#C9A882

Accent · Monogram · Gold

APPROVED COLOUR COMBINATIONS

SOLÈNE

Noir Doux · Ivoire

PRIMARY

SOLÈNE

Ivoire · Noir Doux

REVERSED

SOLÈNE

Or Sable · Noir Doux

ACCENT USE

SOLÈNE

Brun Fumé · Lin

EDITORIAL

SOLÈNE

Ombre · Or Sable

CAMPAIGN

SOLÈNE

Ivoire · Cendre rule

STATIONERY

COLOUR USAGE RULES

ALWAYS

- Noir Doux is the default for all type on light backgrounds
- Or Sable used sparingly; one accent per composition maximum
- Maintain the warm undertone; Ivoire, never pure white (#FFFFFF)
- All backgrounds stay within the tonal family; no pure black

NEVER

- Never use saturated or chromatic colours anywhere in the brand
- Never use pure white (#FFF) or pure black (#000); use Ivoire and Noir Doux
- Never pair Or Sable with Ivoire; too low contrast, reads as error
- Never use more than 3 colours in a single composition

TONAL SCALE : LIGHT TO DARK

Ivoire : lightest

Or Sable sits outside the neutral scale as the sole accent

Noir Doux : darkest

COLOUR IN CONTEXT

CAMPAIGN · DARK MODE

EDITORIAL · LIGHT MODE

MONOGRAM · OR SABLE

5.2 — The Eight-Colour System, Documented

Colour	Hex Code	Role & Usage
Noir Doux	#1E1B17	Primary dark : logo, type, dominant compositions.
Brun Fumé	#3D3830	Secondary dark : rules, dividers, supporting structure.
Ombre	#4A4238	Depth : campaign backgrounds, shadow tones.
Cendre	#8C8277	Mid-tone : sub-labels, metadata, secondary text.
Lin	#C8C2B8	Light : borders, dividers, supporting surfaces.
Craie	#DDD8D0	Very light : inactive states, subtle backgrounds.
Ivoire	#F7F4F0	Page white : the brand canvas. Never pure white.
Or Sable	#C9A882	Accent : monogram, gold, one use per composition maximum.

5.3 — Three Strategic Decisions Behind the Palette

Tonal family, no saturation

Each color within the system is muted and warm, providing an inherent visual harmony through all touchpoints without needing to be actively managed. The introduction of one saturated color within the system anywhere will throw off the register of any composition it is included in; hence, the rule must be followed in all situations.

French naming system

Noir Doux, Brun Fumé, Or Sable – these aren’t just hex codes but are the names that Solène gives its colors, giving them strategic meaning and purpose. By naming its colors in such a way, Solène develops its unique language that is solely its own while at the same time showing its fluency within the European market.

Or Sable: one accent only

Gold is used only once in each composition. It is the restraint that provides the luxury here; by limiting the use of gold, it becomes more noticeable when it appears in compositions.

5.2 — The Eight-Colour System, Documented

Combination	Application
Noir Doux + Ivoire	Default application: the standard combination at every brand interaction point.
Ivoire + Noir Doux	Reverse: for use in light background situations where dark type is needed.
Or Sable + Noir Doux	Accent application: for use in monogram and seasonality campaigns only.
Brun Fumé + Lin	Editorial : used for lookbook and campaign support pages.
Ombre + Or Sable	Campaign : for use in hero campaign occasions, like seasonal launch campaigns.
Ivoire + Cendre rule	Stationery — for use in printed materials and package insertions.

ALWAYS / NEVER

ALWAYS: Noir Doux is the default for type on light backgrounds. Or Sable is used sparsely, one accent at most in each composition. Warm undercolor must be maintained – Ivoire, not white (#FFFFFF). Backgrounds are always in the color family, never pure black.

NEVER: saturate or chromatically color anywhere within the system. Use pure white or pure black : use Ivoire and Noir Doux. Use Or Sable with Ivoire (too little contrast to read properly). More than three colors in any composition.

o6 — Decision: The Logo System

More letter spacing than weight. The è carries everything the logo needs.

6.1 — The Complete Logo System

SOLÈNE — LOGO SYSTEM
PRIORITY 03 · THREE VERSIONS · ALL COLOURWAYS

LIGHT · DARK · GOLD
EACH VERSION TESTED

VERSION 01 — PRIMARY WORDMARK



Application on: Header of website · Shopping bag · Hang tag · Cover of look book · Stationery · Press Release
Theory: Just the name. More letter spacing than weight. The è carries all the graphic character the logo requires – no subline, no support.

VERSION 02 — EDITORIAL WORDMARK



Usage: Political campaign posters; packaging inserts; emails; swing tickets; lookbook inner pages; gift wrap
Concept: The combination of the fine rule and the tagline, “Dignified · Always,” ensures that the promise of the brand is built right into its logo. This is effective in places where more information needs to be conveyed than just the name.

VERSION 03 — MONOGRAM MARK



Use on: Clothing labels · Embossed leather goods · Buttons · Jewellery box lids · Wax seals · App icon · Social media profile picture · Favicon
Logic: A square mark rather than circular – more architectural, less approachable-brand. The thin border is the container, not decoration. At small sizes (app icon, button), drop the Solène sub-label and let SL stand alone.

USAGE AT A GLANCE

NEVER DO

- Stretch or compress the wordmark
- Replace è with e
- Use any weight above Light (300)
- Add drop shadows or effects
- Place on busy backgrounds

MINIMUM SIZES

Version 01 — 120px wide minimum
Version 02 — 160px wide minimum
Version 03 — 32px wide minimum

Below these: use SL mark only

APPROVED COLOURS

- ☒ Noir Doux on Ivoire
- ☐ Ivoire on Noir Doux
- ☒ Noir Doux on Or Sable

6.2 — Version 01: Primary Wordmark

Just the name. More space between letters than weight. The è holds all the graphical elements necessary for the logo without any subline or device. It appears on the header of the website, shopping bag, hang tag, lookbook cover, business card, and press release documents.

6.3 — Version 02: Editorial Wordmark

The presence of the rule and “Dignified · Always” tagline makes sure that the brand message is encoded in the logo. In situations where more information should be included in the design than the name only, this logo is the best choice : packaging inserts, email signatures, swing tickets, and the inner pages of the lookbook.

6.4 — Version 03: Monogram Mark

A square mark rather than a circular one — more architecture and less approachability as a brand. The thin rule works as a container rather than an embellishment. At small sizes (app icon, button), the sub-label Solène is omitted completely. It can appear on the clothing label, embossing leather products, buttons, the lid of the jewellery box, wax seal, app icon, and the social media profile picture.

6.5 — Four Strategic Decisions Behind the Logo

Decision	Rationale
Three versions, three contexts	Wordmark used for the website, packaging, and press. Editorial text + tagline for campaigns, emails, and lookbooks. Monogram SL used on labels, buttons, wax seal, and for the app icon. Never overlap with each other : no versions can be swapped with another.
No icon, no emblem	Typography is the mark. A brand confident enough to leave its name on its own says everything about the quiet confidence that Solène is all about. Any sort of decorative elements would undermine the very restraint the brand relies on.
The è is non-negotiable	Never used interchangeably with the letter ‘e’. It’s the one and only visual element that will make the logo look unmistakably European and out of reach : that’s exactly what the brand needs.
Wide tracking, single weight	Letter spacing plays the role of bolding usually associated with it. Space is the element just as much as typeface is. Too heavy weight would communicate the very opposite of confidence.

6.6 — Usage Rules at a Glance

Never Do	Minimum Sizes	Approved Colours
Stretch or compress the wordmark	Version 01 — 120px wide minimum	Noir Doux on Ivoire
Replace è with e	Version 02 — 160px wide minimum	Ivoire on Noir Doux
Use any weight above Light (300)	Version 03 — 32px wide minimum	Noir Doux on Or Sable
Add drop shadows or effects	Below these thresholds: use SL mark only	
Place on busy backgrounds		

07 — Brand Voice & Typography

The voice of the brand is the brand’s voice. It should remain consistent when writing an Instagram caption, responding to a comment, drafting an influencer outreach email, or writing the text for a hang tag. The voice is not a style guide to be looked up once in a while : it is a discipline that should be exercised every time words are written for the brand.

7.1 — Typography System

Two fonts. Two roles. Period. If there is a third typeface used by the brand, a decision was made without realizing it, a decision which shows that the brand is unsure of itself.

Role	Typeface	Usage & Notes
Display / Headlines	Cormorant Garamond, Medium	Campaign headlines, lookbook names, seasonal launches headings, and any other voice statements. Italics only for emotional emphasis. Never for decoration.
Body / Captions / UI	DM Sans	All Instagram captions, body copy on the website, product descriptions, and all other body copy. Simple and neutral ; does not compete with the display type.

7.2 — Voice Guidelines: Do and Do Not

Do	Do Not
Short, declarative sentences. One idea per sentence.	Multiple clauses that hedge, qualify, or explain themselves.
Present tense. Assertive, with no qualifications at all.	Language that hedges: “we believe,” “maybe,” “perhaps,” “in our view.”
Interior monologue voice : personal, not broadcasted.	Promotional enthusiasm: “We’re SO excited!” “SHOP NOW!!!”
Invoke emotion. Let the reader complete the sentence.	Highlight product specifications within the caption: “soft material, 3 colors, shipping is free.”

Do	Do Not
Talk to readers who know what you're talking about.	Mention the philosophy of the brand in all the posts as if you are seeing it for the first time.
Punctuation for rhythm and pauses, not out of necessity.	Exclamation marks. Regardless of anything. All posts. Forever.

7.3 — Brand Voice Examples

CAPTIONED VOICE — DIRECT FROM THE BRAND IDENTITY BOARD

"She doesn't dress to impress. She dresses to remember."

"Crafted with intention. Worn without explanation."

"For the woman who needs no introduction."

7.4 — Brand Tagline

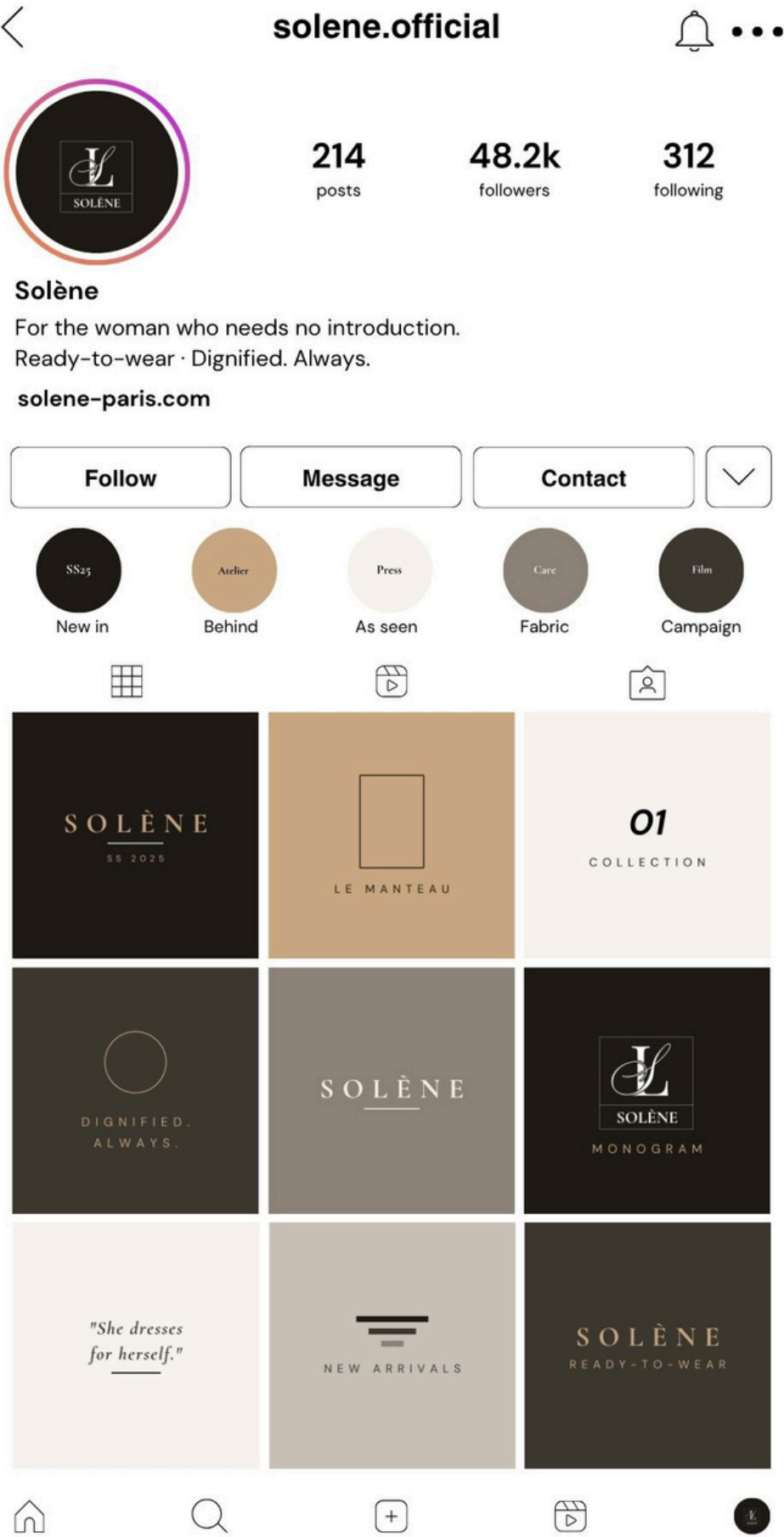
"Dignified. Always." is a timeless promise and not a seasonal description. It defines the brand's tone regardless of collection, campaign, and trends cycle, and most importantly, it is built in a way that makes it impossible for it to ever become untrue. Tagline created out of an attribute or a price range eventually becomes a contradiction of itself. Tone-driven tagline never does.

08 — Execution: Instagram Architecture

The brand, alive.

Instagram is the main channel of the brand's communication. It is where a prospective follower creates his/her first impression, where the audience decides whether to continue or not, and where the brand's visual identity is brought to life. This section showcases the executed Instagram presence.

8.1 — The Executed Profile



8.2 — Grid Logic

The grid operates on the basis of dark, mid, and light rhythm across three columns: texture detail, editorial look, and text card. In other words, the grid presents itself as a whole visual composition before even one of its posts is opened, 3×3 thumbnail view works as an independent brand message separate from any post in particular.

Grid Element	Strategic Function
Bio Copy	"For the woman who needs no introduction." One phrase. It creates the audience for the brand before any product image is shown. Seven words define the whole tone of the brand.
Highlights Architecture	SS25, Atelier, As Seen, Fabric, Campaign : five categories which create the atmosphere of the brand and not just listing its products.
Post Type Rotation	Posts featuring brand mark, editorial look, text card, monogram, quotes, and product naming, all of them designed using the tonal palette only.
Pre-Publish Discipline	Each post gets reviewed against the background of the whole 3×3 grid before being published. If there is anything breaking the visual rhythm of the composition, the post won't get published even if it stands out on its own.

8.3 — Profile Metrics as Strategic Demonstration

The profile page has been created using sample data which would look like after implementing the branding strategy for a while (214 posts, 48.2K followers, 312 following). These numbers serve purely an illustrative purpose and are not based on real-life performance.

09 — Execution: o€ Organic Growth Strategy

The model below is an attempt at creating an organic growth model based on existing social media marketing principles. Actual outcomes would vary depending on many other factors.

The o€ constraint is not a limitation. It is the discipline.

Paid reach speeds discovery but doesn't form community. While organic reach is slower, it builds followers who discovered the brand, selected the brand, and stuck with it. These are followers that are more likely to convert into customers and brand advocates. The framework outlined below works on six tracks at once. Isolating any one track without the others generates far less value.

9.1 — Track One: Content Engineered for Saves

Saves are widely considered one of the strongest engagement signals on Instagram. The viewer finds the post compelling enough to revisit, and the algorithm interprets save rates as a signal of quality, distributing such posts widely among new audiences. Everything is thus built to answer one question: will they save this?

- Style guides ("5 ways to wear this piece") have the highest save rates of all content types in fashion. They're practical, aspirational, and continually referred to over time.
- Mood board carousels ("The aesthetic for this season") get shared and saved directly to DMs by friends, word-of-mouth marketing via a tap of the screen.
- Text-statement Reels make something the viewer wishes to save and send somewhere else. Every brand voice example in Part VII is carefully created for this purpose.
- Content showing the behind-the-scenes processes of making something – how the lookbook was shot, how the palette was selected – gets saved by audiences that place importance on visible craftsmanship.

9.2 — Track Two: The 30-Minute Engagement Ritual

In the first thirty minutes after each post is published, the algorithm is analyzing whether or not the content is of high quality based on initial engagement signals. Engagement in this window has an outsized impact on future distribution.

1. Reply to every comment in the first 30 minutes of publishing. Even a one-word reply serves as an engagement signal to extend organic reach.
2. Direct Message highly engaged followers who regularly interact with content with a simple personalized message: "Thanks for saving this, it really means a lot." This is unique enough that it will stick out, and it fosters one-on-one loyalty right at the point when every interaction with a new follower is being formed.
3. Each response to a story comment should be made via voice rather than text. The closeness of a voice response creates loyalty much faster than text replies.
4. Check and respond to comments left on older posts during this exact same time period. The algorithm recognizes activity on your account, not just activity on individual posts.

9.3 — Track Three: Community Seeding

The account needs to be seen before it can be followed. The quickest way to get seen by a target audience with no cost is to show up where that audience already exists.

- Practice daily: 20–30 minutes on 10–15 relevant accounts, commenting only on real and substantial posts.
- Accounts targeted are the ones that the audience already follows (brands such as Totême, ARKET, COS, Acne Studios, Lemaire) along with the editorial accounts and the micro-influencers in the same aesthetic space.
- The algorithm connects an account with accounts that it interacts with regularly. Consistent interaction on the accounts that post about luxury and minimal fashion helps train the algorithm to show the Solène content to similar audiences.
- Commenting for self-promotional purposes is strictly forbidden at all costs; once a user sees a comment as promotional, all credibility gained through previous interactions goes away in one second.

9.4 — Track Four: Hashtag Architecture

Tier	Size Range	Function
Brand Hashtag (1 tag)	0 posts : owned entirely by the brand	Establishes a database of all the brand content which is accessible in search.
Niche Luxury Tags (3 tags)	10,000–200,000 posts	So specific that a person looking through actually wants to see content of this kind. High-intent audience.
Broad Fashion Tags (3 tags)	500,000–2,000,000 posts	High reach, low conversion rate. Acts as a category signal for the algorithm, not an audience building tool.

Hashtag count per post: total of exactly seven hashtags. Research shows diminishing returns beyond ten and potential spamming signals beyond twenty hashtags. The hashtag structure is reviewed monthly.

9.5 — Track Five: Collaboration Content

Before the audience is organically formed, collaboration becomes the tool through which the audience is borrowed. Aesthetic compatibility is the one and only non-negotiable criteria of choice when selecting the collaboration partner. Not the number of followers.

- Editorial Reels collaborations: two brands with common aesthetic view, targeting the same audience with one content item.
- Story takeovers: a day-long collaboration when both brands post to each other's accounts, reaching their pre-selected taste-compatible audience.
- Tag trades: each brand mentions the other's product in their editorial content for free.

9.6 — Track Six: Email List from Day One

An Instagram account is rented property that is subjected to algorithm changes, so the email list is the owned platform and its development since the first week of existence is just a risk management practice.

- The bio link redirects users to a landing page that only features a single email capture field and an exclusive offer: “Get first access before anyone else.” It isn’t about the discount; it’s about the early access, which correlates with the brand positioning.
- Effective Reels generate a “Comment EDIT to get the style guide” DM funnel to turn engaged viewers into email subscribers automatically.
- Email sends are monthly and editorial in nature, not promotional at all. Proposed target figures for benchmarking: 50 subscribers in 30 days and 300 subscribers in 90 days, provided that there is consistency in the execution.

10 — Execution: The Silence Before

“She dressed in the dark. She knew every button.”

“The Silence Before” is the name of the campaign designed to introduce Solène’s SS 2025 collection. The campaign strategy is based on one single emotional idea: the moment before a woman steps into the room. The idea builds the emotional context before any products appear, the aspiration without transaction, where the feeling comes before the object – just like luxury marketing should be done.

10.1 — The Full Campaign Moodboard

SOLÈNE

CAMPAIGN MOODBOARD

SS 2025 · "THE SILENCE BEFORE"

ART DIRECTION REFERENCE

CONFIDENTIAL

"The Silence Before": a campaign about the moment before a woman enters the room.

THE SILENCE BEFORE

SOLÈNE SS 2025

"She dressed in the dark. She knew every button."





FABRIC TEXTURE



WOVEN · CREPE · SILK SATIN

SOLÈNE

DIGNIFIED · ALWAYS



MOOD & DIRECTION

LIGHT DIRECTION

Single source.
Raking light from the side. Long shadows.

SET & LOCATION

Empty interiors.
Stone floors. Tall windows.
No furniture.

MODEL DIRECTION

Still. No smiling.
Eye contact or looking away. Never mid-motion.

COLOUR GRADE

Desaturated warm.
Lifted blacks.
No crushed shadows.

VISUAL REFERENCES

Flemish portraits

ART REF

Luchino Visconti

FILM REF

Peter Lindbergh

PHOTOGRAPHY

Totême SS24

FASHION REF

Agnes Varda

DIRECTOR REF

CAMPAIGN COPY

HERO LINE

"The silence before she enters the room is already her."

SECONDARY LINE

"She doesn't dress to be seen. She dresses to feel complete."

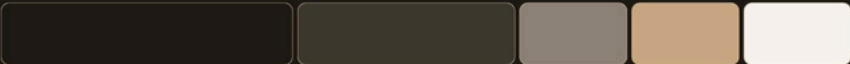
PRODUCT COPY TONE

"Cut from double-faced wool. Made to outlast the season."

CLOSING LINE

"Dignified. Always."

CAMPAIGN PALETTE APPLIED



60%

20%

8%

6%

6%

10.2 — Art Direction

Direction Element	Specification
Specification	Single source. Raking light from the side. Long shadows throughout.
Set & Location	Empty interiors. Stone floors. Tall windows. No furniture present in frame.
Model Direction	Still. No smiling. Eye contact or looking away, never captured mid-motion.
Colour Grade	Desaturated warm tones. Lifted blacks. No crushed shadows anywhere in the edit.

10.3 — Visual References

Campaign Art Direction is influenced by five particular references, chosen for each one due to the special feature which should be taken from the reference into account:

Reference	What It Contributes
Flemish Portraits	Quality of single source lighting and lack of movement in the facial expression.
Luchino Visconti (Film Reference)	Pace and mood of European cinematography : slow, unhurried.
Peter Lindbergh (Photography)	Natural, unretouched intimacy in fashion photography.
Totème SS24 (Fashion Reference)	Competitor as an example of restrained styling.
Agnès Varda (Director Reference)	Feminine view that just observes, but does not pose for the shot.

10.4 — Campaign Copy

FULL CAMPAIGN COPY SET

HERO LINE: “The silence before she enters the room is already her.”

SECONDARY LINE: “She doesn’t dress to be seen. She dresses to feel complete.”

PRODUCT COPY TONE: “Cut from double-faced wool. Made to outlast the season.”

CLOSING LINE: “Dignified. Always.”

10.5 — Campaign Palette Application

The core brand palette is used in the campaign in the following percentage distribution among the visual materials: 60% for Noir Doux and 20% for Ombre are used as the dominating dark tones; 8% for Cendre serves as the middle tone, 6% for Or Sable as the accent tone and 6% for Ivoire as the visual breathing room.

II — Execution: The Quiet Drop

A seasonal launch is not a product announcement. It is the opening of a world.

The Quiet Drop is the framework for the four-week launch campaign that will be used to introduce the SS 2025 collection based on “The Silence Before.” The strategy includes a particular goal for each week, followed by specific content creation that will take the audience through an emotional journey instead of making an announcement once.

II.1 — Week 1: The Teaser

Objective: create suspense without any explanation. Do not show any products and do not introduce any brand names, only atmosphere and feeling. At this stage, the audience should feel that something is about to happen but not know what.

Content Piece	Execution Detail
Reel: Texture Study (60 seconds)	No product shown. Daily environment Stories show pure atmosphere without any brand presence.
Grid Post	An abstract composition of the color palette. Caption: launch date.

II.2 — Week 2: The Reveal

Objective: present the collection as the world's first and the product as the second thing to come. This sequence will protect the emotional concept developed during Week 1.

Content Piece	Execution Detail
Hero Collection Reel (45 seconds)	The first complete introduction of the collection. The world opening instead of the product drop.
Grid Drop	Three grid posts released within one hour. Story countdown redirects to a live link in bio.
Personal Outreach	Private preview of the direct message sent individually to 50 most engaged followers before launch.

II.3 — Week 3: The Validation

Objective: create social proof through the voices of others besides the brand's. This is the week where collaboration content and UGC tell the story.

Content Piece	Execution Detail
Micro-Influencer Content	Live content from influencer partners aligned with the brand, chosen for aesthetic fit rather than number of followers.
Brand Story Carousel	A 10-slide carousel taking the audience through the story and craft of the brand.
Styling Reel	"3 Ways to Wear" format Reel demonstrating versatility of a hero piece.
UGC Repost	UGC repurposed with attribution to a genuine member of the community or a customer.

II.4 — Week 4: The Close

Objective: end this campaign with a final statement that is cinematic and urgent yet still within the framework of the brand's tone of voice.

Content Piece	Execution Detail
Final Editorial Reel	A final cinematic piece to serve as the cap to the four weeks of content.
Inventory Honesty	Factual stock updates (like “only 12 left”) in a way that doesn’t induce panic.
Campaign Recap Carousel	A recap in the form of a carousel looking back at the four-week journey.
Community Thank You Post	Closing post centered around the community not the product itself.

II.5 — Campaign Output Summary

Asset Type	Quantity	Distribution
Reels	12	3 per week across the 4-week arc
Static Grid Posts	6	Concentrated in Weeks 1, 2, and 3
Carousels	2	Brand story (Week 3) and campaign recap (Week 4)
Stories	28+	Daily presence sustained across the full campaign

12 — The Outcome: Market Position

From invisible to irresistible.

The final section below details what Solène is able to do with the system built out here that another brand without such a strategic framework would not be able to do.

12.1 — What This Brand Would Be Positioned To Do

- Support a premium pricing strategy from launch through strong perceived value.
- Appeal more to micro-influencers who align aesthetically.
- Create a content stream that converts strangers into followers at once owing to instant harmony of the visuals.
- Launch a campaign where the product is not yet revealed, creating an expectation for it – breaking the standard order of revealing the product and explaining the strategy behind it.
- Build towards a goal of 300 subscribers within 90 days through consistent organic execution.
- Find its place in the market niche between Sandro and Totème.

12.2 — Why Each Strategic Decision Is Defensible

Decision	Strategic Justification
Controlled Minimalism	The toughest aesthetic discipline to pull off. Maximalism might have cover in volume; minimalism has no place to hide. Choosing it is its own statement of strength.
Tonal Palette, No Saturation	All the colors have been stripped of saturation and tinted warm, ensuring harmony in all touchpoints. One saturated color could disrupt every composition it enters.
No-Logo Positioning	In today's luxury climate, it's the lack of an explicit logo that makes the luxury statement. Authority at Solène is gained through craftsmanship and restraint, not through repeating a monogram.
"Dignified. Always."	A promise rather than a descriptor, applicable seasonally or not; crafted in such a way that it can never be broken.
Optimising for Saves	Saves are generally considered stronger indicators of content value because they suggest intent to revisit the content.

Decision	Strategic Justification
"The Silence Before"	A campaign name that builds emotional context even before the products arrive, aspiration that isn't linked to commerce. The emotion happens before the object.

CLOSING STATEMENT

This document represents end-to-end brand thinking, from the diagnosis through identity to the activation.

Every decision is strategic, documented, and defensible.

Solène isn't the subject of this piece of work. Solène acts as an example showing that branding choices can be converted into identity, content strategy and launching strategy.

Portfolio Project . Conceptual Brand Strategy . Not Commercially Implemented

SOLÈNE
DIGNIFIED . ALWAYS
